



Staff Attendance, Timekeeping & Documentation Standards

ILS Staff Training | Clock-ins, cancellations, hospitalization, and daily service notes (DSNs)

Please complete the Staff Attestation at the end of this training.

What We'll Cover



Clocking In & Out

Pay, lateness, and why every punch matters



Service Delivery

Direct, in-person services



Cancellations & Interruptions

What to do and how pay works



Client Hospitalization

Quick review of staff withdrawal



Daily Service Notes (DSNs)

When and how to write them



Note Reviews

Feedback, retraining, and corrective action

Clocking In & Clocking Out

All staff must clock in and clock out for every session.

- Clock in at the start of your session and clock out at the end — every time.
- If you are late, you are late. You are paid for the time you actually work.
- Exception: sessions canceled or interrupted by the client (see Cancellations).
- Clock out only after your DSN is complete.



Paid for time worked

Late arrival = shorter paid time. Your clock-in and clock-out are the record of your session.

Missed Clock-Ins & Clock-Outs

This is extremely important.

1

Missed punch

Clock-in or clock-out not recorded



2

Not verified

We cannot confirm it was worked to completion



3

Can't bill

The agency cannot bill for that session



4

Write-up

Repeated missed punches lead to a written warning

Tip: set a phone reminder for your clock-in and your DSN/clock-out time.



All services are direct service and in-person

...unless management has approved otherwise.

Do not switch a session to remote or indirect service on your own. Get approval from management first.

Client Cancellations & Interruptions

If a client cancels

Inform management immediately. We will try to assign you another case to work.

After the 2nd cancellation or session interruption, management will reach out to the client and family to discuss attendance.

1

You accept the work offered

You are paid for the new work.

2

You decline the work offered

You are not paid for the canceled session.

3

We can't find other work

The session time is changed to Miscellaneous and you are paid.

Quick Review: Client Hospitalization

Staff withdrawal once a client is admitted



Notify

Tell management right away when you learn a client has been hospitalized.



Withdraw

Stop scheduled ILS services while the client is admitted, per the protocol.



Wait

Do not resume services until management confirms the client is cleared.

Refer to the full Client Hospital Admission and Staff Withdrawal Protocol for details.

Completing Your DSN

Daily service notes are done at the END of the shift.

Clock in → Direct service with the client

Last 10–15 min: DSN

Clock out

- Review which goals you worked on and how.
- Enter your notes as required.
- Then clock out.



DSNs are time-stamped

If a DSN is completed at the beginning or middle of a session, you will be asked to stop working.

Every Note Answers These Questions

1 What skill was practiced?

2 What did the client do?

3 What support or teaching did staff provide?

4 How did the client respond?

5 What needs to happen next? (when there is follow-up)

Prioritize 1–4

Every entry must clearly answer questions 1 through 4. Add #5 when follow-up is needed.

Mark "Yes" carefully

Mark Yes only for goals you actually worked on during the session.

Weak Note vs. Strong Note

Example: budgeting goal

Weak

"Worked on budgeting. Client did good."

Doesn't say what the client did, what staff taught, or how the client responded.

Strong

(1) Practiced weekly budgeting. (2) Client listed bills and wrote down her grocery budget. (3) Staff modeled subtracting bills from income and used a checklist. (4) Client completed 3 of 4 steps on her own and needed a prompt for the last. (5) Next session: practice with receipts.

Note Reviews & Corrective Action

Management reviews notes regularly.

1

Review

Notes are checked against the documentation standard.

2

Feedback & retraining

If notes fall short, we review them with you and provide more training.

3

Corrective action

If notes continue to not meet the standard, corrective action will be taken.

Key Takeaways

- Clock in and out for every session. You are paid for time worked.
- Missed punches mean unbillable sessions and can lead to a write-up.
- Services are direct and in-person unless approved.
- Report cancellations to management immediately.
- Report hospitalizations right away and withdraw per protocol.
- Write DSNs in the last 10–15 minutes, then clock out.
- Answer questions 1–4 in every note; mark Yes only for goals worked.



Next step

Read the Quick Reference Guide
and sign the Staff Attestation.